Historical Britannica: extracted source

Supplement to the fourth, fifth and sixth editions of the Encyclopaedia Britannica - Volume 5 - EB.12

Source row 2263. Parser: nvidia/nemotron-3.5-parse.

This is model-extracted text, not a corrected transcription. OCR errors, reading order and region alignment require human review.

Region region-0; provider order 0.

It is needless to say, that neither Leibnitz nor Collins admitted the fairness of the infer-ences which Clarke conceived to follow from the scheme of necessity: But almost every page in the subsequent history of this controversy may be regarded as an additional illus-tration of the soundness of Clarke's reasonings, and of the sagacity with which he anticipat-ed the fatal errors likely to issue from the system which he opposed.

Region region-1; provider order 1.

" Thus (says a very learned disciple of Leibnitz, who made his first appearance as an author about thirty years after the death of his master)'–Thus, the same chain embraces the physical and moral worlds, binds the past to the present, the present to the future, the future to eternity."

Region region-2; provider order 2.

" That wisdom which has ordained the existence of this chain, has doubtless willed that of every link of which it is composed. A CALIQUIA is one of those links, and this link is of iron: A MARCUS AUELIUIS is another link, and this link is of gold. Both are necessary parts of one whole, which could not but exist. Shall God then be angry at the sight of the iron link? What absurdity! God esteems this link at its proper value: He sees it in its cause, and he approves this cause, for it is good. God beholds moral monsters as he beholds physical monsters. Happy is the link of gold! Still more happy if he know that he is only fortunate. 2 He has attained the highest degree of moral per-fection, and is nevertheless without pride, knowing that what he is, is the necessary result of the place which he must occupy in the chain."

Region region-3; provider order 3.

" The gospel is the allegorical exposition of this system ; the simile of the potter is its summary."3 (Bonnet, T. VIII. pp. 257, 238.)

Region region-4; provider order 4.

In what essential respect does this system differ from that of Spinoza? Is it not even more dangerous in its practical tendency, in consequence of the high strain of mystical de-votion by which it is exalted?4

Region region-5; provider order 5.

tion, has given to the concluding paragraphs of his remarks on Collins, an earnestness and a solemnity of which there are not many instances in his writings. These paragraphs cannot be too strongly recom-mended to the attention of those well-meaning persons, who, in our own times, have come forward as the apostles of Dr Priestley's " great and glorious Doctrine of Philosophical Necessity."

Region region-6; provider order 6.

1 Charles Bonnet, born 1720, died 1793.

Region region-7; provider order 7.

2 The words in the original are, " Heureux le chainon d'or l plus heureux encore, s'il sait qu'il n'est qu' heureux." The double meaning of heureux, if it render the expression less logically precise, gives it at least an epigrammatic turn, which cannot be preserved in our language.

Region region-8; provider order 8.

3 See Note (U.)

Region region-9; provider order 9.

4 Among the various forms which religious enthusiasm assumes, there is a certain prostration of the mind, which, under the specious disguise of a deep humility, aims at exalting the Divine perfections, by annihilating all the powers which belong to Human Nature. "Nothing is more usual for fervant devotion (says Sir James Mackintosh, in speaking of some theories current among the Hindous), than to dwellso

Region region-10; provider order 10.

Source record

bri-2263-b5ad7bf6945b

Image SHA-256: b5ad7bf6945bf79046c219ca7afbc543

669e9d587851209753c99b9bfbcb84ad

Dataset revision: 309f765b1ecc83e0a7f7762e44b4a927a7555443

National Library of Scotland, Encyclopaedia Britannica Illustrated (CC0).

https://huggingface.co/datasets/NationalLibraryOfScotland/encyclopaedia_britannica_illustrated/viewer/default/train?row=2263